

Resilience

Resilience is the ability to bounce back after disappointment and to learn from mistakes. It can determine a person's ability to cope with pressure, setbacks, and stress, and to persevere through tough times.

Managing adversity

Life is full of ups and downs—and the pressures and stresses of everyday life, as well as more traumatic life events (such as bereavement or illness), affect a person's happiness and sense of well-being. A big part of growing up is learning to manage adversity and become stronger than before.

► Tools for life

Resilience enables a person to avoid feeling overwhelmed, anxious, or depressed in the wake of a challenging situation.

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◀ 86–87 Confidence and self-esteem

Stress 92–93 ▶

Goals and ambitions 112–113 ▶



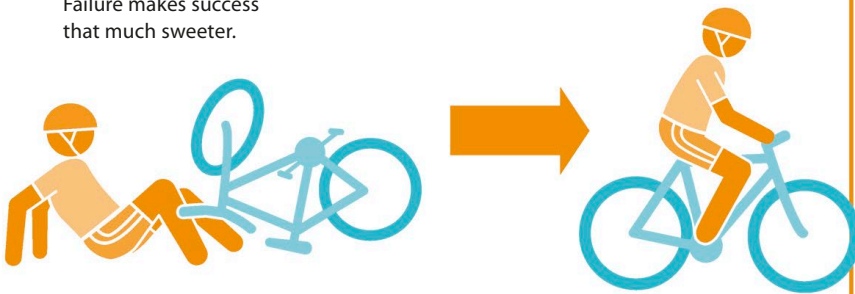
Learning to fail

Trying new things or taking risks can be scary and, when things go wrong, it can be distressing or embarrassing, particularly if others are unsupportive. Yet, it's important not to feel too disheartened—there is actually a lot to be gained from failure.

The experience of failure teaches teens that they can cope with setbacks and improves their ability to adapt and solve problems. With more knowledge of the task, its requirements, and themselves, teens are better placed to achieve their goal in the future.

▽ Have confidence

Failure makes success that much sweeter.



"It is impossible to live without failing at something, unless you live so cautiously that you might as well not have lived at all—in which case, you fail by default."

J. K. Rowling

Negative thinking

When something goes wrong, negative thought patterns can hinder a person's ability to deal with a problem or setback.

Ignoring a problem

Although distraction can provide temporary relief, ignoring a problem will not make it go away. Plan time to tackle the issue and ask for support if needed.

Blaming oneself

Thinking incessantly about a mistake only makes it worse. Instead, recognize what went wrong, and plan what you'd do differently next time.

Catastrophizing

When something goes wrong, it can seem as if it's impossible to fix, or as if everything else is falling apart, too. Try to put things into perspective by asking a friend to give you a more objective point of view.